take over, convergences of values and interests between India and the West started to take shape. After all, there is much that they do share, including a liberal democratic political model, similar governance practices, a credible market economy and commitment to the rule of law. That India after Independence chose to continue its close ties with the English-speaking world was a politico-cultural decision of no small consequence. Over years thereafter, a very substantive relationship that covered politics, security, trade, investment, services, innovation, education and development assistance was built up, especially with the US and the UK. This was characterized by extensive contacts between civil societies and institutions. The large Indian diaspora in many Western societies strengthened the bonding.

At challenging moments in India's contemporary history, economic and military support from the West has made a critical difference. This was particularly the case in the 1960s, after the border conflict with China, and during years of famine. India was the largest recipient of development assistance from Western nations and the multilateral banks they controlled. As it embarked on reforms thirty years ago and shifted to higher growth rates, the West was again supportive of this trajectory. They have also advanced India's political interests thereafter in the international system, including through the Indo-US nuclear deal and its membership of various export control regimes. On the major international issues of the day, such as terrorism, maritime security or connectivity, there is now a considerable meeting of minds. This relationship has increasingly made itself felt in global affairs, especially after 9/11.

The European Union, the UK and the US are among the top economic partners and sources of capital, technology and best practices that are necessary for India's modernization. The maturing of ties is also reflected in two-way flows, with Indian companies now emerging as significant foreign investors in Western economies. The politics of these ties has kept pace. While the India-US relationship, in particular, has flowered in recent years, the 'third option' that Europe has long represented on strategic issues has grown in importance. These accumulated developments have today created high degree of comfort between India and the West.